

031. Chapter 3 Verses 16-18

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.16

एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥ 16 ॥

*evam pravartitam chakram nānuvartayatiha yaḥ
aghāyur indriyārāmo mogham pārtha sa jīvati*

evam—thus; pravartitam—set into motion; chakram—cycle; na—not; anuvartayati—follow; iha—in this life; yaḥ—who; agha-āyuh—sinful living; indriya-ārāmaḥ—for the delight of their senses; mogham—vainly; pārtha—Arjun, the son of Pritha; saḥ—they; jīvati—live

The man who does not follow the cycle thus set revolving is a sinner rejoicing in sense-pleasures and he lives in vain.

VERSE 3.17

यस्त्वात्मरतिरेव स्यादात्मतृप्तश्च मानवः ।
आत्मन्येव च सन्तुष्टस्तस्य कार्यं न विद्यते ॥ 17 ॥

*yas tvātma-ratir eva syād ātma-triptaś cha mānavaḥ
ātmanyeva cha santuṣṭas tasya kāryam na vidyate*

yaḥ—who; tu—but; ātma-ratiḥ—rejoice in the self; eva—certainly; syāt—is; ātma-triptaḥ—self-satisfied; cha—and; mānavaḥ—human being; ātmani—in the self; eva—certainly; cha—and; santuṣṭaḥ—satisfied; tasya—his; kāryam—duty; na—not; vidyate—exist

But he who rejoices, who is contented, who finds happiness in Atma only, has no work to perform.

नैव तस्य कृतेनार्थो नाकृतेनेह कश्चन ।
न चास्य सर्वभूतेषु कश्चिदर्थव्यपाश्रयः ॥ 18 ॥

naiva tasya kṛitenārtho nākṛiteneha kaśhchana
na chāsya sarva-bhūteṣhu kaśhchid artha-vyapāśhrayaḥ

na—not; **eva**—indeed; **tasya**—his; **kṛitena**—by discharge of duty; **arthaḥ**—gain; **na**—not; **akṛitena**—without discharge of duty; **iha**—here; **kaśhchana**—whatsoever; **na**—never; **cha**—and; **asya**—of that person; **sarva-bhūteṣhu**—among all living beings; **kaśhchit**—any; **artha**—necessity; **vyapāśhrayaḥ**—to depend upon

For him, there is in this world no interest whatsoever by work done or not done. He does not depend upon any being for any object.